Thomas BÉZY

Paris School of Economics
Office R5-32
48 Boulevard Jourdan
75014 Paris, France

Email: thomas.bezy@psemail.eu
Homepage: www.thomas-bezy.com

Research interests

Primary: Public Economics
Secondary: Environmental Economics

References

Lucas Chancel
Associate Professor
Sciences Po
lucas.chancel@sciencespo.fr

Cecile Gaubert
Associate Professor
UC Berkeley
cecile.gaubert@berkeley.edu

Antoine Levy
Assistant Professor
UC Berkeley Haas
levya@berkeley.edu

Katrin Millock
Full Professor
Paris School of Economics & CNRS
millock@univ-paris1.fr

Stefanie Stantcheva
Full Professor
Harvard University
sstantcheva@fas.harvard.edu

Education

Paris School of Economics - Ph.D. Candidate *2022-2026*
Supervisors: Katrin Millock and Lucas Chancel

UC Berkeley - Visiting Ph.D. *2024*
Supervisor: Antoine Levy

London School of Economics - Visiting Ph.D. *2024*
Supervisors: Daniel Sturm and Swenja Surminski

Harvard University - Predoctoral Program *2021-2022*
Supervisor: Stefanie Stantcheva

Paris School of Economics - M.A. *2019-2021*
Highest Honors - Master's Thesis Supervisors: Lucas Chancel and Thomas Piketty

Ecole Normale Supérieure Paris-Saclay *2018-2022*

Professional Affiliations and Positions

- **Research Fellow at World Inequality Lab** *2022-Present*
  Paris School of Economics
- **Research Fellow at Social Economics Lab** *2021-2022*
  Harvard University
- **Research Assistant** *2020-2021*
  France Strategie, Services of the Prime Minister

Job Market Paper

Flood Insurance Affordability Beyond Subsidies: A Welfare Analysis of Public Reinsurance
There is growing uncertainty over whether natural disaster insurance can remain affordable as climate change drives escalating losses. Several countries have addressed this issue with public reinsurance, which substantially lowers insurance premiums in floodplains but, in doing so, also encourages construction there. Combining geolocated administrative data at the building level from France, Belgium, and Switzerland, I provide a welfare analysis of public reinsurance. First, in an event study framework, I find that the additional floodplain construction induced by public reinsurance leads to a modest 5% increase in flood damage costs between 1982 and 2100. Second, I use these reduced-form estimates to discipline a spatial equilibrium model with an embedded insurance market. I find that public reinsurance yields substantially larger welfare gains than a subsidized insurance system similar to the US, no matter the level of subsidy chosen. Depending on the welfare function, these gains can be as large as total current flood damages in France. While the literature has focused on finding the optimal level of insurance subsidies, this paper shows that alternative policies can deliver larger welfare gains.

Publications

Real Estate Wealth Inequality and Exposure to Natural Disasters with Evidence from France, Forthcoming at *Nature Communications*

How can we Explain the Recruitment Difficulties Anticipated by Companies?, joint with Catherine Bruneau, Cédric Crofils, Etienne Lavenant and Dimitris Mavridis, 2024, *Economics and Statistics 544, 55–73*

Working Papers

Insuring Landlords, joint with Antoine Levy and Tim McQuade, *NBER working paper*, submitted

Work in Progress

Who's your Landlord? Assortative Matching and Heterogeneous Returns in Rental Markets, joint with Antoine Levy

Me vs Others: Perception Gaps and Support for Redistribution, joint with Francesco Nuzzi and Stefanie Stantcheva

Should Disaster Insurance Serve as a Tool for Urban Planning?

Policy Reports

Réinventer la solidarité assurantielle face aux effets inégalitaires du réchauffement climatique, joint with Lucas Chancel, 2025, *World Inequality Lab Policy Brief*

Exposure to Floods of New Build Homes: A comparative analysis between France and the UK, joint with Viktor Rozer and Swenja Surminski, *Grantham Research Institute Working Paper*

Seminars and conferences

2026: PSE Applied Lunch Seminar, Paris Environmental Economics Workshop, Urban Economics Association European Meeting, Queen Mary University of London PhD workshop, World Inequality Conference, HEC PhD workshop, AMSE Louis-André Gérard-Varet conference, World Conference on Environmental and Resource Economics, Labor and Public Economics PSE Seminar, Environmental Economics Seminar PSE, Paris Tax Workshop, Chaire Economie du Climat Seminar, Erasmus University Housing Policy workshop, AFSE conference on public policy evaluation
2025: ACPR lunch seminar, PSE Applied lunch seminar, Séminaire Chaire PARI, PSE environmental seminar, PSE World Inequality Lab internal seminar
2024: SciencesPo Inequality and the Environment Symposium, OECD Lunch Seminar, LSE Workshop on Climate Change and Inequality, AERE Summer conference, AMSE Louis-André Gérard-Varet conference, LSE Economics department seminar, LSE Geography and Environment department seminar, LSE Grantham Research Institue seminar, NBER Summer Institute Real Estate, SITE Financial Regulation, Berkeley trade seminar, Berkeley public finance seminar and Berkeley finance seminar
2023: PSE Public Economics Internal Seminar, LSE Environment Day, Urban Economics Association Annual Meeting, PSE Applied Lunch Seminar

Honors and Awards

Chaire Mesure de l'économie research grant (€4,000)
Agence Nationale de la Recherche (ANR) Grant (€2,000)
Fondation Palladion Research Grant (€10,000)
Chaire PARI PhD Grant (one year funding)
PSE Stone Center Research Grant (€5,000)
PSE Mobility Grant (€4,000)
World Inequality Lab Research Grant (€2,000)
Agence Nationale de la Recherche (ANR) Grant (€5,000)
University Paris 1 Pantheon Sorbonne PhD Grant (three years funding)
Ecole Normale Superieure Paris-Saclay Grant (four years funding)

Teaching

Undergraduate Microeconomics at *Université Paris Sciences Lettres (PSL)*, 2027
Applied Econometrics for Master students at *Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne*, 2023
Undergraduate Econometrics at *Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne*, 2023
Undergraduate Mathematics at *Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne*, 2022
Undergraduate Mathematics at *Université de Paris*, 2021

Languages

French: Native
English: Fluent